

The Personality

Blogs are not objective. They give you biased opinions, and you know it. In a way, they're much like reading letters from someone. After a while you can sense that person's values and interests, and you can't remove the person - the personality - from the equation. That would make both writing and reading pointless, or at least transform it to something else than blogging. People write blogs, not the Corporate Communication Department (but people working there can).

The Voice

Closely related to the above, a blog has a voice of its own. An author's voice. There's no template to use. A blogger must dare to be a person instead of an official and a voice will be heard. Most probably it will be an everyday voice; natural, direct and informal, maybe even funny or irritating. Blogging shouldn't be compared to journalism, but you'll find a similarity between Personality/Voice and the ingredients of really good newspaper columns.

The Links

Blogging has been called the Art of Linking and links are a major part of most blogs. As blog readers we want it. With the Web growing absurdly by the minute, we have no chance of keeping up. The blogs do that for us, in often very small niches. But it's not just the links - people have been putting together lists with links since the birth of the Web. With blogs we like, we get the most interesting links with at least some degree of context.

The Conversations

You're not alone out there. There's always other blogs sharing your interests. You become a part of the conversation by linking to those blogs from posts of your own, stating your opinions, publishing related information or thoughts. If you do it well they link to you, and a kind of conversation between blogs has started. It's of course not necessary to actively try to converse, but most bloggers would argue that this is an important part of blogging.